

Leave & Holidays Policy

Version 5.0 · Effective 1 April 2026

Topic	Requirement
Overview	Version 5.0 · Effective 1 April 2026
Entitlements (per calendar year, pro-rated for joiners) - Earned / annual leave	Days: 24; Notes: Accrues 2 days/month. Carry forward max 10. Encashment of up to 10 days on exit (India).
Entitlements (per calendar year, pro-rated for joiners) - Sick leave	Days: 12; Notes: No carry forward. Medical certificate required for 3+ consecutive days.
Entitlements (per calendar year, pro-rated for joiners) - Casual leave (India)	Days: 6; Notes: Max 2 consecutive days.
Entitlements (per calendar year, pro-rated for joiners) - Maternity	Days: 26 weeks; Notes: For the first two children; 12 weeks thereafter. Adoption: 12 weeks.
Entitlements (per calendar year, pro-rated for joiners) - Paternity / partner	Days: 4 weeks; Notes: Within 6 months of birth or adoption.
Entitlements (per calendar year, pro-rated for joiners) - Bereavement	Days: 5; Notes: Immediate family.
Entitlements (per calendar year, pro-rated for joiners) - Marriage	Days: 5; Notes: Once during employment.
Entitlements (per calendar year, pro-rated for joiners) - Volunteering	Days: 2; Notes: Registered NGOs.
Entitlements (per calendar year, pro-rated for joiners) - Sabbatical	Days: up to 3 months unpaid; Notes: After 4 years of service, with VP approval.
Entitlements (per calendar year, pro-rated for joiners)	Local law prevails where it is more generous (e.g. Germany: statutory minimum of 20 days plus company top-up; US: state sick-leave laws).
Applying for leave	Apply in the HRMS at least 7 days ahead for planned leave of 3+ days, and 1 day ahead otherwise.
Applying for leave	The manager approves within 2 business days; if they don't, the request escalates to the skip-level manager automatically.
Applying for leave	Emergency or sick leave: inform the manager the same day and regularise it in the HRMS within 2 days of returning.
Applying for leave	Unapproved absence is treated as loss of pay (LOP).
Leave during notice period	Earned leave cannot be used to shorten the notice period unless the manager and HR approve.
Public holidays	Location-specific. See the Holiday Calendar 2026. Each employee also gets 2 floating holidays per year.
Purpose and scope	This policy ensures employees rest and recover while teams keep delivering. It applies to all employees. Interns receive 1 day of leave per month of internship.
Definitions	Leave year: 1 January – 31 December.
Definitions	Accrual: earned leave is credited on the 1st of each month (2 days).
Definitions	LOP (loss of pay): unpaid absence, deducted at gross ÷ calendar days × LOP days.
Definitions	Sandwich rule: does not apply. Weekends and holidays between leave days are not counted.
Worked examples	Joiner on 1 July: earned leave for the year is 12 days (6 months × 2).
Worked examples	Carry-forward: an employee has 16 unused days on 31 December. 10 days carry forward and 6 lapse. India employees may instead encash up to 5 lapsing days at basic salary in January.
Worked examples	Sick leave over 3 days: 4 days sick requires a registered medical practitioner certificate uploaded within 3 days of returning. Without it, the days convert to earned leave, or to LOP if no balance remains.
Negative balance	Up to 5 days of earned leave may be taken in advance. On exit, advance leave is recovered in the full and final settlement.

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Special situations	Long illness: after sick leave is exhausted, earned leave is used, then up to 30 days of paid medical leave at the People Team's discretion, then unpaid leave.
Special situations	Public holiday during leave: not counted as leave.
Special situations	Compensatory off: for approved weekend or holiday work. Must be used within 60 days.
Special situations	Leave without pay: up to 30 days per year, with manager and HR approval. Benefits continue.
Roles	Employee: plans leave, keeps the team informed, sets an out-of-office message.
Roles	Manager: approves fairly, keeps team coverage, doesn't discourage leave.
Roles	HR: keeps balances, audits LOP, runs encashment.
FAQs	Can my manager reject leave? Yes, for business-critical periods, with a documented reason and an alternative date offered.
FAQs	Is leave encashed on exit outside India? Where local law requires it (e.g. Germany: untaken statutory leave is paid out; US: per state law).
Revision history	5.0 (2026): Paternity leave increased to 4 weeks; volunteering days added.
Revision history	4.0 (2024): Unified global entitlements.